ZHANLI LI（李展利）

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zhanli-li.github.io ⋄ Zhanli-Li (200+ stars) ⋄ Google Scholar: 26 citations

EDUCATION

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law *September 2023 – June 2027*
Wenlan School of Business (Honors College), B.Sc. in Digital Economy
Weighted Avg: 94/100 Rank: 2/80 2025 National Scholarship
Major Courses: Probability and Statistics (99), Machine Learning (98), Mathematical Analysis (97.33), Neural Networks (92)
Research Interests: LLMs, Agentic Training, Document Intelligence, Causal Inference

PUBLICATIONS

Zhanli Li, Huiwen Tian, Lvzhou Luo, Yixuan Cao, Ping Luo. *DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search. EMNLP 2026*, **Under Review**. [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Yixuan Cao, Lvzhou Luo, Ping Luo. *Navigating Large-Scale Document Collections: MuDABench for Multi-Document Analytical QA. ACL 2026* (CCF-A). [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Zichao Yang. *ESG Rating Disagreement and Corporate Total Factor Productivity: Inference and Prediction. Finance Research Letters*, vol. 78, p. 107127, 2025. (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9). [**First Author**]

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search† ***First Author***
October 2025 – February 2026
Proposed **DeepRead**, a structure-aware document reasoning agent that preserves layout fidelity via OCR, constructs **paragraph-level coordinates**, and equips LLMs with **Retrieve** and **ReadSection** tools. Unlike flat chunk-based agentic search, DeepRead explicitly models document hierarchy and reading order, allowing the agent to first locate relevant regions and then inspect complete local context. Under our environment setting, this gives rise to human-like “locate-then-read” reading behavior and improves over **Search-o1** style baselines by an average of **10.3%** across four multi-type document benchmarks.
▷ **Under Review at** *EMNLP 2026*; the preprint was reported by **New Wisdom**.
Paper: https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.05014 **Code:** https://github.com/Zhanli-Li/DeepRead
Media: https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/BhvUQgREp4NOvb6axiWXiQ

MuDABench: Multi-Document Analytical QA Benchmark and Multi-Agent Framework† ***First Author*** *April 2025 – December 2025*
Constructed **MuDABench**, a multi-document analytical QA benchmark with **80k+ pages**, **332 questions**, and **4,964 structured intermediate facts**, to evaluate multi-document retrieval, cross-document aggregation, and numerical reasoning over large document collections. The benchmark uses structured intermediate facts to expose where a system fails: document selection, single-document extraction, cross-document aggregation, or final numerical reasoning. Designed a **Multi-Agent** workflow that substantially improves over standard retrieval baselines.
▷ **Published in** *ACL 2026 (CCF-A)*.
Paper: https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.22239 **Code:** https://github.com/Zhanli-Li/MuDABench **Data:** https://huggingface.co/datasets/Zhanli-Li/MuDABench

SHAP-Based Causal Inference Framework for Corporate Finance* ***Project Leader*** *September 2024 – January 2025*
Built an interpretable machine learning framework combining manually coded panel data and **Optuna** hyperparameter optimization, achieving $R^2 = 0.76$ on corporate total factor productivity prediction. Further

used **SHAP** to quantify the **nonlinear marginal contribution** of ESG rating disagreement to outcome variables and reveal potential causal pathways linking heterogeneous ESG signals with productivity outcomes.
▷ **Published in** *Finance Research Letters* (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9); received the Outstanding Paper Award at the Tsinghua Causal Inference Seminar.
Paper: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.frl.2025.107127 **Media:** https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/5oEEnyVM_0PdWTg-7X8RJA

*†Supervised by **Institute of Computing Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences** professors Yixuan Cao and Ping Luo; *supervised by **Wenlan School of Business** Zichao Yang*

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Meituan LongCat Interaction (Foundation Model Team) *May 2026 – Present*
Role: Research Intern **Mentor:** Feng Hong **Model:** https://longcat.chat/
Project: Environment Scaling for Data Agent post-training; designed **Data World** to synthesize unified latent worlds from explicit causal topologies and construct verifiable, difficulty-controlled heterogeneous environments through **observation-bias injection** and **independent auditing**.
▷ Contributed to the final merged training data for **LongCat 2.0 Pro**, supporting complex long-horizon data analysis.

Beijing Paoding Technology Co., Ltd. (AI Startup) — Research Dept. *June 2025 – February 2026*
Role: AI Research Intern **Mentors:** Ping Luo, Yixuan Cao
Product: https://chatdoc.com/
Project: Improved context retrieval in production-grade RAG systems by optimizing context-missing issues with **PDFlux** and **ChatDOC**; worked on retrieval completeness and document-context preservation for complex financial-document scenarios.

COMPETITION EXPERIENCE

NVIDIA Nemotron Model Reasoning Challenge ***Silver Medal*** *June 2026*
Based on **Nemotron-3-Nano-30B-A3B** and the competition-required **LoRA** fine-tuning setting, built an agentic reasoning framework for abstract puzzle solving and organized induced rules into reusable solvers. Achieved a score of **0.86**, ranking **119/4182** globally.

HONORS & SERVICE

China National Scholarship *November 2025*
Received the highest national-level undergraduate scholarship in China for academic excellence and research potential.

China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling *November 2025*
Won First Prize as team leader; responsible for problem formulation, modeling strategy, algorithm implementation, and final paper organization.

Hunan Province Outstanding Student *April 2023*
Awarded to outstanding high school students in Hunan Province for academic excellence, leadership, and comprehensive development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming / Tools: Python, C/C++, LaTeX, Markdown, Docker, SSH, tmux, Ubuntu **English:** CET-4: 522, CET-6: 508
Libraries & Frameworks: ms-swift, vllm, verl, llamaindex, transformers, torch, sklearn, pandas, numpy